



currently bowl actually help the batter use the pace, get under the ball and power it into the stands. Adil Rashid and Will Jacks bowled almost 8 to 10 km/h slower than the Indian spinners and so were far more effective than them.

Disappointing though the results were for the Indian fan, there is a lot of hard work ahead for the team. A good, honest reflection on what the shortcomings were and how to overcome them is the need of the hour. Shot selection is very important and here the batter has to rein in his ego and not try to live up to an image, but play the ball on its merits. Yes, in the ultra-short format, the T20, it is not easy to do so as big shots are needed virtually every other delivery. But it is different in the ODI format, where there is time for a short period of settling down before the power shots are unfurled.

Above all, it's necessary to play smart cricket. So, figure out the bowler who doesn't need to be counter-attacked. Then target the bowlers against whom you can make up for the quiet over from the better bowler.

No team in the world has five top bowlers,

Course correction: The author insists boundary sizes must be increased when the new Indian season begins, so batters are better prepared for next year's World Cup. GETTY IMAGES

and there will always be eight to 12 overs in a T20 game where the runs can be looted. Similarly, in the 50-over format, a little patience won't hurt even if the team is chasing a big score like 380-plus.

Most of all, it's mandatory that if a player is an average fielder, he has to be shown the door. There is simply no way a captain has to hide three or four players, hoping the ball won't go anywhere near them. The bowlers also must look at the slow bouncer once again and see how cleverly Sam Curran used the slow, loopy deliveries.

As I said, there's no need to press the emergency button as yet. However, there's plenty of honest introspection needed. There also has to be a lot more thought put into the execution of each individual's speciality if the Indian team is to get back to winning ways.